

Football-Specific Standardised On-Pitch Concussion Assessment Protocol (FOCUS)

Location	Domain	Guidance
Touchline	Player medical history	Know: Player medical and concussion history 
	Mechanism of injury	Consider: Mechanism of injury Observe: Player lying motionless 
	Visible signs	Observe: • No protective action • Seizure • Tonic posturing • Motor incoordination • Vomiting • Abnormal emotional/behavioural response • Possible skull fracture • Abnormality of head/neck • Blood/clear fluid from ear(s) • Periocular/retroauricular haematoma • Pupil abnormalities  Observe: • Superficial face/head injury/nosebleed • Blank/vacant look 

Key:  In case of abnormality, lower threshold for concern + continue assessment

 In case of abnormality, substitute player + further assessment and treatment off pitch

Location	Domain	Guidance
Pitch	Level of consciousness	Assess: ACVPU scale Ask: What happened? What is last thing player remembers?
	Cervical spine assessment	Assess/ask: • Midline neck tenderness • Restricted active range of neck motion • Unexplained limb strength and/or sensation abnormality • Numbness/tingling
	Symptoms	Ask: • Headache/pressure in head • Feel normal • Drowsy • Disorientated • Difficulty concentrating • Nauseous • Blurred/double vision • Feeling slowed down • Normal hearing
	Orientation	Ask: What venue? Which half? Which team scored last? Which team played against last week? Win/lose/draw?
	Balance	Observe: Tandem stand with eyes closed Ask: Dizziness, balance difficulties
	Proprioception	Observe: Finger to nose with eyes closed (left and right index fingers)
	Oculomotor	Observe: • Smooth pursuit (side to side, up and down) • Convergence
	Activity-based assessment	Observe: Change-of-direction sprint Ask: Symptoms provoked
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